TRILIUM SYMBIONT · GITHUB.COM/CHAELLER/TRILIUM-SYMBIONT

Knowledge Management and AI

My journey to an agent-assisted second brain in Trilium



MY JOURNEY

Where my knowledge lives today – outside my brain ;-)

Where	What it is for	Verdict
📁 Markdown files per git repo	Docs for the AI, next to the code	✅ Keep
🔎 Kiro `/knowledge` with my project KnowledgeBase	RAG-like knowledge base for large content: downloaded Jira tickets, SharePoint, Confluence	⏳ Keep for now; later maybe AI-agnostic using RAG
🧠 Automatic memory of the AI agent tool (Claude, Kiro)	Like a subconscious: convenient, but at risk of being lost	👍 Nice to have
📝 Trilium Notes Application	My personal docs	✅ Keep: very good user experience
📚 AI agent assisted Second Brain LLM Wiki by Andrej Karpathy	A personal second brain that scales; based on Markdown, typically used together with the Obsidian tool	❓ Did not use it, because I would like to have it in Trilium Notes

💡 MY PRIVATE PROJECT IDEA:

Bring the LLM Wiki into Trilium: the AI agent works with my notes through **Trilium's built-in MCP server**, and keeps the LLM Wiki pattern of **small index notes that scale**: the agent reads only the index and the notes it needs, instead of filling the whole content into the context window of the LLM.

WHY TRILIUM

Markdown yes, Obsidian no: Trilium is my favourite PKM app

Great user experience

Rich editor, fast navigation in the note tree

Self-hosted

My data on my server, synced to every device

Clones and attributes

One note in many places; labels and relations

Built-in MCP server

Ready for AI agents, plus ETAPI for scripts

A SECOND BRAIN WITH TRILIUM

What a personal second brain should do

Retrieve

Dump raw content in, find it again fast

Curate

Like a librarian: consolidate and archive automatically

Editable

Manual maintenance is always possible

AI-agnostic

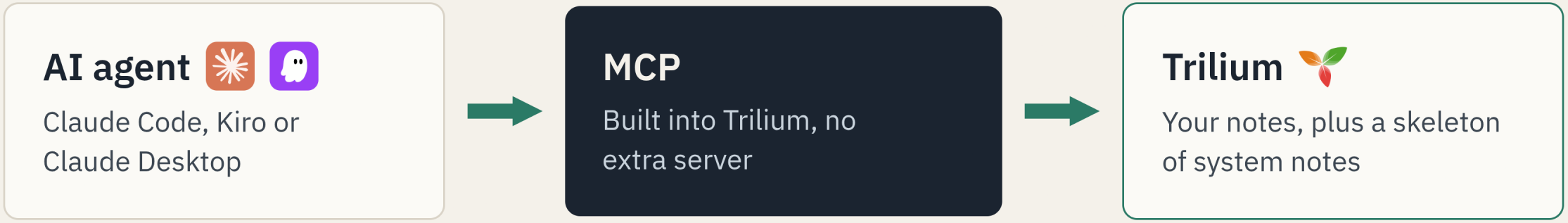
Local AI, Claude, Kiro; per repo or global, via skills, plugins or MCP

INSPIRED BY ANDREJ KARPATHY'S LLM WIKI, MAPPED ONTO TRILIUM

LLM Wiki	In Trilium
Immutable sources	The Sources space: articles, docs, research, kept unchanged
Compiled synthesis	One synthesis per hub; every statement links to its source
Index	Hubs/_Index and the hub pages
Log	Append-only _Log notes for every agent change
Lint	/sb-lint: a health check that reports, never fixes
Schema	_Schema rulebooks the agent reads first

THE BASE IDEA

Your AI agent, connected to Trilium



So in my free time I wrote an extension for Trilium and published it as open source on GitHub.

Trilium Symbiont `github.com/chaeller/trilium-symbiont`

A thin layer on top of Trilium: **a note structure, a rulebook and 12 skills** that let the agent capture, compile and query your knowledge efficiently.

THE STRUCTURE

Four spaces under the Trilium root

Daily

Journal and inbox for quick captures

Cockpit

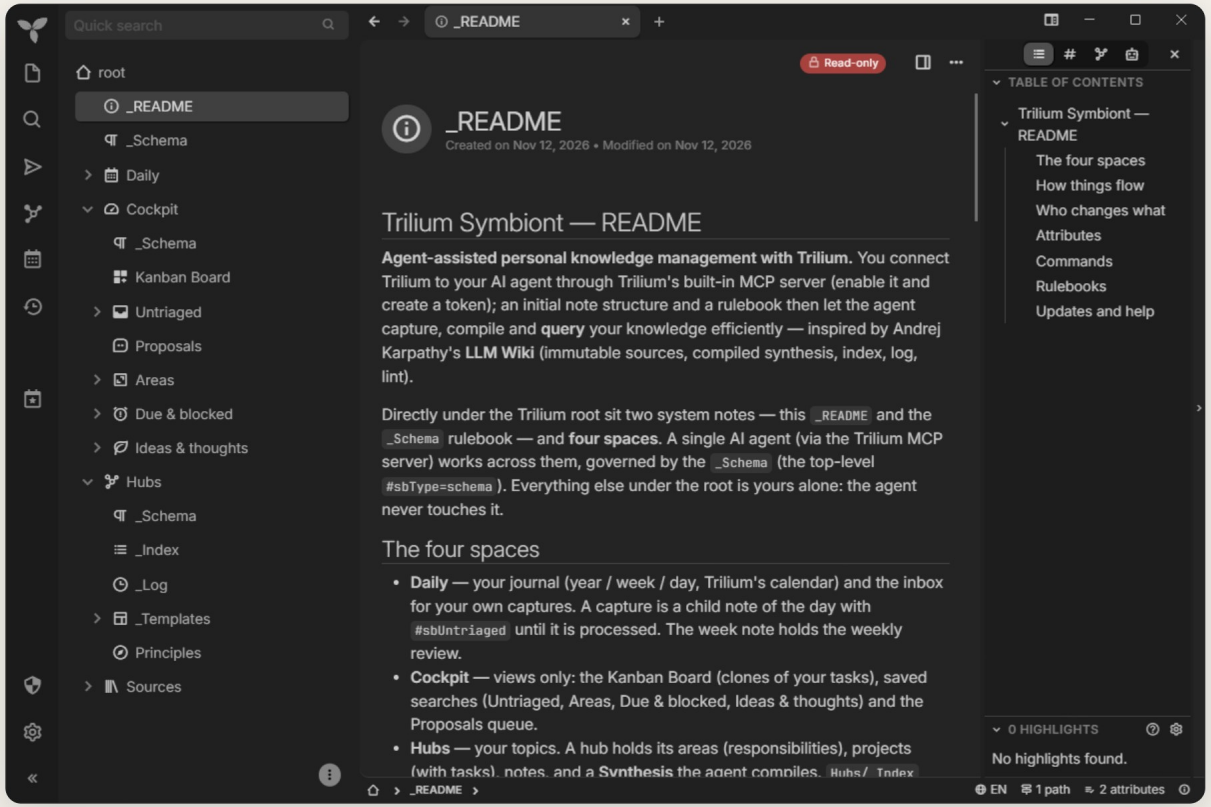
Kanban Board, saved searches, agent proposals

Hubs

Topics with areas, projects, tasks and a synthesis

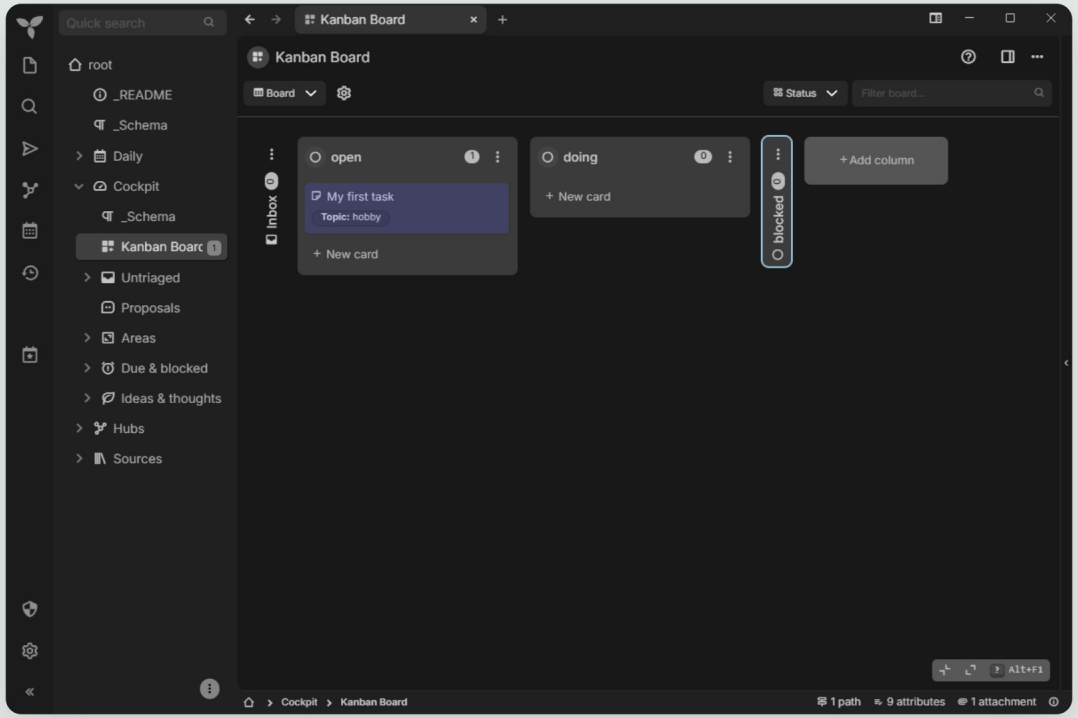
Sources

Foreign material, kept unchanged

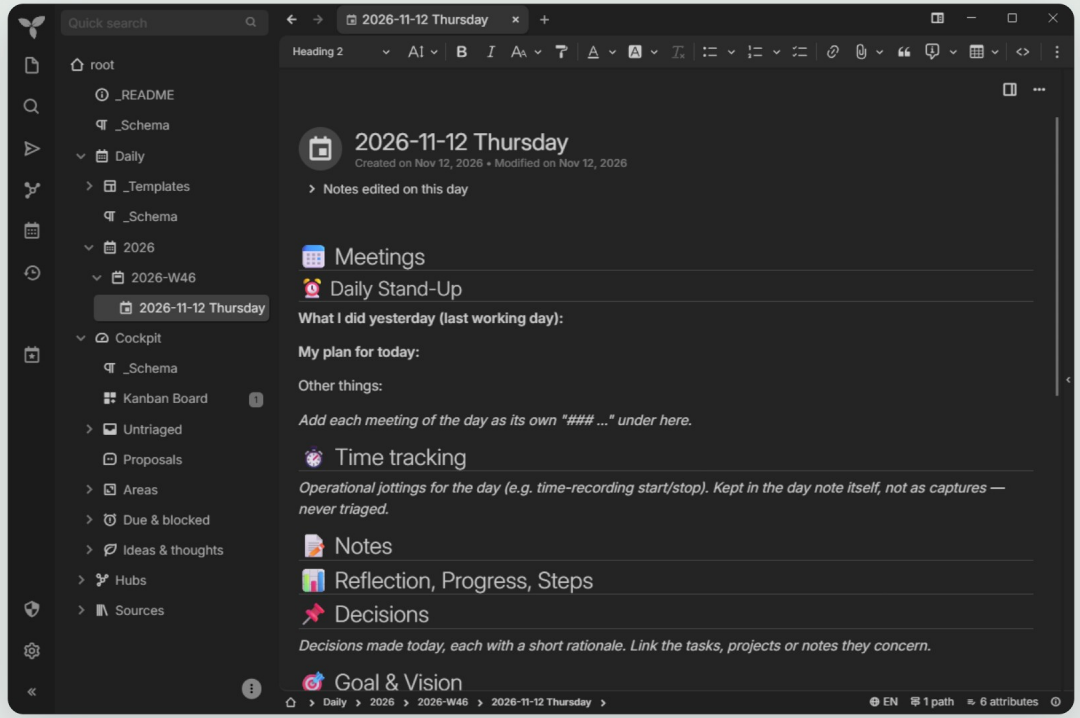


DAY TO DAY

Plain Trilium features, used by the agent



Cockpit: a Kanban Board with a clone of every task



Daily: a journal note per day; captures become its children

12 SKILLS

Slash commands, or just ask in plain language

/sb-capture Jot into today’s journal	**/sb-triage** File captures into hubs	**/sb-task** Tasks with a card on the Board	**/sb-daily** Day note and weekly review
/sb-query Answers with citations	**/sb-research** Web research into Sources	**/sb-ingest** Compile sources into syntheses	**/sb-hub** Create or refresh a hub
/sb-review Proposals, areas, maturity	**/sb-lint** Health check, report only	**/sb-init** Build the skeleton once	**/sb-sync** Update rulebooks from the repo

MY VISION

From second brain to personal assistant

Today every workflow starts with my request. Next, the AI should use the Symbiont as a personal assistant, with some automation on top.

The next step: an **agentic OS**, like Hermes, that runs the assistant and keeps the Symbiont as its long-term memory.

